

## 12. Open up . . . your floor plan, that is

Extra rooms can really result in a great deal of unused space. While this is of no concern to most people anyway, it's of particular note when dealing with small homes. Poorly planned closets and pass-through halls can seriously cut down on your usable square feet. — **Myscha Theriault**

## How to Get Rid of Your Junk

Are you barely able to breathe in your cluttered household? Have tons of stuff that you need to get rid of? Many times the process of uncluttering is stopped short for emotional reasons. Here are some popular ones:

### I PAID SO MUCH FOR IT!

Yes, but are you getting your money's worth from it? If you are not using that antique dresser, and it's just collecting dust and spiderwebs, sell it. Ignore the *Antiques Roadshow* fantasies.

### I HAVE SENTIMENTAL ATTACHMENT TO IT.

This is my biggest problem.

### SOMEONE ELSE WILL BE ANGRY IF I SELL IT / GIVE IT AWAY.

The best way to deal with gifts that are no longer providing you with use or pleasure is to contact the giver. Let the giver know that you are trying to simplify your life, and that although you appreciate the thought that went into the gift they gave you, you simply aren't using it. You can ask if they would like it back, or if they have any input as to what you should do with it. This can be a difficult proposition, but many people appreciate the honesty. The other option is to get rid of it and just tell them that you broke it if they ever ask, but it's easier in the long run to be up-front when dealing with friends and family.

### MY CHILDREN WILL EVENTUALLY WANT IT.

Keep in mind that what you like now isn't necessarily going to coincide with what your children will